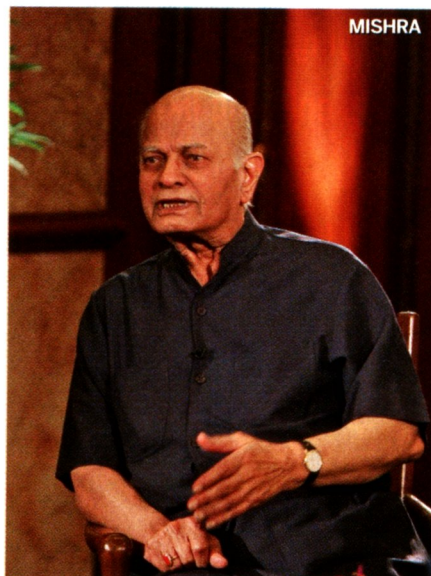


DELHI | Total Recall

Why did the prime minister summon Brajesh Mishra to his residence on December 1? The former national security advisor in the NDA Government drove to Race Course Road amid rumours that the current NSA had resigned. But no, neither had M.K. Narayanan quit nor was Manmohan Singh offering Mishra the job. Instead, Manmohan wanted to discuss Operation Parakram carried out by the NDA soon after the 2001 Parliament attack during which troops were deployed along the Indo-Pakistan border for nearly 10 months. The issue had come up during the Congress Working Committee meet the evening before when the party debated whether to emulate the NDA's move. *by Priya Sahgal*

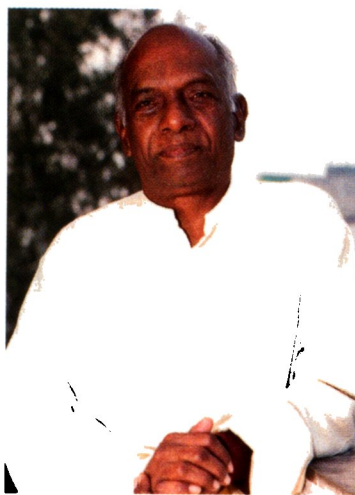


MISHRA

Act Two

Three years after the Right to Information (RTI) Act was implemented, the Union Government has authorised a study "to understand the key issues and constraints in implementing the RTI Act". PricewaterhouseCoopers (PWC) is conducting the survey. The firm stirred controversy when it advised privatisation of water supply in Delhi a few years ago. PWC will be paid Rs 69.09 lakh for the survey. RTI activists allege that PWC does not have the expertise to carry out the study. *by Shyam Lal Yadav*

DELHI | Together Again



VIKRAM SHARMA

GOVINDACHARYA

After eight years in exile spent studying the impact of globalisation, K.N. Govindacharya has returned to politics, and launched a new organisation, the Rashtriya Swabhiman Andolan. The RSA will be allied with Uma Bharati's Bharatiya Jan Shakti (BJS). The role of the RSA, says the ideologue, mirrors that of the RSS in that "it will work for the BJS as the RSS works for the BJP". The former RSS pracharak has no time for either the BJP or the Congress, claiming it is his party which is both "pro-poor and pro-India".

by Shyam Lal Yadav

CHANDIGARH | Singh Operation

Former Punjab chief minister Amarinder Singh is using the 'terrorism' card to attack Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal and his son, SAD President Sukhbir Singh. Amarinder accused the father and son of carrying out "political terrorism" against the Opposition Congress and for the murder of 48 Congress supporters by party workers six months ago. *by Ramesh Vinayak*



NARENDRA BISHT

AMARINDER

SIGNPOSTS

WON: By pugilist **M.C. Mary Kom** (below), the fifth AIBA World Championships in Ningbo City, China in the 46-kg category. This was her fourth successive gold. **L. Sarita** won a gold in the 52-kg event.

QAMAR SIBTAIN



DIED: Urdu poet **Rifat Sarosh**, 84, a pioneer of modern Urdu literature who authored over 55 books.

DIED: **Y.P. Chibbar**, 76, People's Union for Civil Liberties general secretary. He worked with civil liberties movement in the country for over 30 years.

DIED: Ex-Bihar Assembly speaker **Shiv Chandra Jha**, 76, and former cabinet minister in Chandra-shekhar Singh and Bindeshwari Dubey's governments.



APPOINTED: Vice-Admiral **Anil Chopra** as the director-general of the Coast Guard following Vice-Admiral Rusi Contractor's retirement. Chopra was the flag officer commanding the Western fleet.